

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, key of D major (three sharps), and 2/2 time. The melody is characterized by a mix of 2/2 and 3/2 measures, creating an irregular feel. Chord diagrams for guitar are provided above the staff at various points: E (open strings), B (x2, 4, 4, 2, 1), and A (x2, 4, 4, 2, 1). The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across measures. The score ends with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...